

Jihye Lee

Ph.D. Candidate, Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis

jihye.l@wustl.edu | jihyelee.org | [Google Scholar](https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=jihyelee)

EDUCATION

Washington University in St. Louis, Brown School, St. Louis, MO

Ph.D. Candidate in Social Work, 2023-present

Advisor: Mitra Naseh, Ph.D.

Dissertation Beyond Access: Digitally Mediated Employment and Refugee Integration across Infrastructure, Practice, and Institutional Support in the United States
Committee Drs. Mitra Naseh (Chair), Melissa Jonson-Reid, Patrick Fowler, Jin Huang, Stephen Roll

Chung-Ang University, School of Social Work, Seoul, Korea

Master of Social Work, 2021

Chung-Ang University, School of Social Work, Seoul, Korea

Bachelor of Arts in Social Work, 2019

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Topics Poverty and Economic Integration; Digital Inclusion; AI-Mediated Work/Services
Populations Immigrants; Refugees; Racially/Ethnically Minoritized Populations
Methods Survey-Weighted Analysis; Computational Social Science (Natural Language Processing, Machine Learning, Network Analysis); Mixed Methods

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Articles

15. Lee, J., Naseh, M., Zeng, Y., Bechara, S. & Hamilton, B. (2026). Multidimensional Poverty and Perceived Discrimination Among Newly Resettled Afghans in the U.S. *Journal of Immigrant & Refugee Studies*. 10.1080/15562948.2026.2670689
14. Lee, J., Naseh, M., Badiezadeh, S., Taridashti, S. & da Luz Scherf, E. (2026). Health Impacts of Migration and Policy on the Iranian Diaspora. *Journal of Immigrant and Minority Health*, 28(1), 78-88. 10.1007/s10903-025-01844-1
13. Yoo, N., Lee, J. & Jang, S. (2026). E-Government Engagement and Subjective Well-Being During the COVID-19 Pandemic: Comparing North Korean Refugees and Native Koreans. *Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies*. 10.1080/1369183X.2026.2706353
12. Zeng, Y., Naseh, M., Lee, J. & Bechara, S. (2026). From First Jobs to Better Pay: Predicting Refugee Wage Mobility with Machine Learning. *Journal of the Society for Social Work and Research*. 10.1086/740324
11. Ibrahim, H., Brugger, L., Lee, J. & Roll, S. (2026). Disproportionate Economic Hardships of COVID-19 on Immigrant Households. *Children and Youth Services Review*. 10.1016/j.childyouth.2026.109185

10. Da Luz Scherf, E., Naseh, M. & **Lee, J.** (2026). Migration Policies as Social Determinants of Health Among International Graduate Students in the United States. *Journal of Immigrant and Minority Health*. 10.1007/s10903-026-01948-2
9. Bechara, S., Naseh, M., Zeng, Y., **Lee, J.** & Baker, J. (2026). Afghan Refugees' Multidimensional Deprivation: Comparative Analysis of St. Louis, Portland, and a National Refugee Sample. *Journal of the Society for Social Work and Research*. 10.1086/742826
8. Naseh, M., Qushua, N., Nartey, P., **Lee, J.** & Razzak, R. B. (2026) A Scoping Review of Economic Integration Interventions and Programs for Refugees. *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*. 10.1057/s41599-026-07331-8
7. Taridashti, S., Naseh, M., Garcia, E. M. Z. & **Lee, J.** (2025). Health Impacts of Restrictive Migration Policies: A Qualitative Study of Highly Educated Iranian Immigrants and International Students in the U.S. *Journal of Immigrant and Minority Health*, 1-11. 10.1007/s10903-025-01760-4
6. Brugger, L., Bellisle, D., Maag, E., Udani, A., Roll, S., Hamilton, L. & **Lee, J.** (2025). Child tax credit utilization in immigrant households: a focus on child investment and college funds. *SN Business & Economics*, 5(9), 109. 10.1007/s43546-025-00871-2
5. Chung, Y., Maguire-Jack, K., Pei, F., **Lee, J.**, & Chang, Y (2025). The Mediating Role of Social Cohesion between Neighborhood Disorder and Child Maltreatment Behaviors across Childhood. *Journal of Family Violence*, 1-11. 10.1007/s10896-025-00988-w
4. Naseh, M., **Lee, J.**, Zeng, Y., Nabunya, P., Alvarez, V. & Safi, M. (2024). Understanding Economic Integration in Immigrant and Refugee Populations: A Scoping Review of Concepts and Metrics in the United States. *Economies*, 12(7), 167. 10.3390/economies12070167
3. Chen, J., Jones, D., **Lee, J.**, Yan, Y., Hsieh, W. J., Huang, C. H., ... & Drake, B. (2024). Do the benefits of homeownership on mental health vary by race and poverty status? An application of doubly robust estimation for causal inference. *Social Science & Medicine*, 116958. 10.1016/j.socscimed.2024.116958
2. Chang, Y., Maguire-Jack, K., Yoon, S. & **Lee, J.** (2022). Family-, school-, and neighborhood- level predictors of resilience for adolescents with a history of maltreatment. *Children*, 10(1). 10.3390/children10010001
1. **Lee, J.** & Moon, S. (2022). Analysis of Research Trends in Youth After-school Academy: Focusing on Keyword Network Analysis. *Social Science*, 61(2). 10.22418/JSS.2022.8.61.2.441

Working Papers and Policy Briefs

2. Naseh, M., **Lee, J.**, & Bechara, S. (2026). *What drives refugees' high poverty in the early years after U.S. resettlement?* Migration Policy Institute. [\[LINK\]](#) [\[LINK\]](#)
1. Naseh, M., Bechara, S., Zeng, Y., **Lee, J.**, & Potocky, M. (2026). Adaptation and Initial Validation of the U.S. Census Multidimensional Deprivation Index for Resettled Afghans (Working Paper No. 01). Forced Migration Initiative. 10.7936/f4tn-p468

14. **Lee, J.**, Bechara, S, Zeng, Y. & Naseh, M. Multidimensional poverty among newly resettled refugee households: evidence from the 2020-2022 Annual Survey of Refugees. *Journal of International Migration and Integration*. [R&R]
13. **Lee, J.**, Naseh, M., Chen, J., Badiezadeh, S., Zamora Garcia, E. & Chow, C. (2026). Liminal Legality and the Organization of DACA Scholarship: Keyword Co-occurrence Networks Across Presidential Administrations, 2013–2026. *Journal of the Society for Social Work and Research* [R&R]
12. **Lee, J.**, Dusard, L., Bechara, S. & Naseh, M. Enough for a Household? Individual wages and household poverty among newly resettled refugees in the United States. *Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies*
11. **Lee, J.**, Yoo, N., Bechara, S. Zeng, Y., & Naseh, M. From displacement to settlement: a scoping review of predictive AI in refugee and immigration services. *International Migration*.
10. **Lee, J.** & Yoo, N. Testing the social diversification hypothesis after resettlement: digital skill, social capital, and online economic activity among North Korean refugees and South Koreans. *Universal Access in the Information Society*.
9. **Lee, J.**, Bechara, S, Zeng, Y. Haran, H., & Naseh, M. Getting by without getting ahead: low-barrier gig work and the early economic integration of newly resettled Afghans in the U.S. *Journal of Refugee Studies*.
8. Yoo, N., **Lee, J.** & Jang, S. (2026). Domain-specific patterns of perceived AI usefulness among North Korean refugees and native Koreans: A Latent Profile Analysis. *Journal of Psychology and AI*. [R&R]
7. Chow, C. & **Lee, J.** Policy models of immigrant political incorporation: conceptualization and empirical cases in Asian developed economies using fuzzy sets. *The Asian and Pacific Migration Journal*. [R&R]
6. Yoo, N., **Lee, J.**, Cureton, A. & Chow, C. Peer support and digital mutual aid among DACA recipients under liminal legality: a computational text analysis of Reddit community. *International Migration Review*
5. Yoo, N., **Lee, J.**, Min, S. & Kim, Y. Material hardship and livelihood coping strategies among refugees in South Korea. *Journal of Human Rights and Social Work*
4. Naseh, M., **Lee, J.** Badiezadeh, S. & Safi, H. Afghan refugees' conceptions of economic integration in the United States. *Journal of Sociology & Social Welfare*.
3. Naseh, M., Badiezadeh, S., **Lee, J.**, Rafieifar, M. & Suarez, C. Social connectedness, integration, and quality of life among newly resettled Afghan refugee households in the United States. *SAGE Open*. [R&R]
2. Naseh, M., Bechara, S., Badiezadeh, S., **Lee, J.** & Baker, J. Structural barriers and facilitators in accessing employment for refugees in Missouri. *Journal of the Society for Social Work and Research*. [R&R]
1. Ilkkursun, Z., Bechara, S., Badiezadeh, S., **Lee, J.** & Naseh, M. Post-Resettlement Determinants of Mental Health Among Refugee Adolescents in Germany: A Secondary Social Ecological Analysis. *Child Indicators Research*. [R&R]

Works in Progress

4. **Lee, J.**, Rafieifar, M. & Naseh, M. Uneven by programme: self-reported arrival status, SNAP and Medicaid receipt, and material hardship among Afghan arrivals in the United States
3. Yoo, N. & **Lee, J.** Generative AI in immigration services: a scoping review of target users, access barriers, and governance reporting
2. Yoo, N., **Lee, J.**, Zhang, X. & Ki, D. Reducing Administrative Burden Using Multilingual AI Assistants Among Immigrants.
1. Lee, J., **Lee, J.** & Zhang, L. Federal and State Unemployment Insurance Policies and the Duration of Extended Benefits Availability During COVID-19.

FELLOWSHIPS AND COMPETITIVE PROGRAMS

Washington University in St. Louis, Clark-Fox Policy Institute, Graduate Policy Scholars Program, 2026–2027. Selected Scholar-in-Training; interdisciplinary training in policy practice and social justice across graduate and professional schools [[LINK](#)]

University of Michigan, Institute for Social Research, 2026 ISR Symposium on Complexity, “Place as Method, Theory, and Responsibility: Rethinking Scientific Inquiry for Complex Social Issues,” Selected as one of 35 early-career scholars; full travel support provided. Ann Arbor, Michigan. October 7-9, 2026. [[LINK](#)]

Toronto Metropolitan University, Global Migration Institute, 2026 Global Migration Institute Winter School, “Digital technologies and migration studies: Impacts on governance, research methods, and ethics”, Selected participant; partial program support awarded. Toronto, Canada. November 9-13, 2026. [[LINK](#)]

UC Davis, Global Migration Center, 2026 Summer School in the Economics of Migration, Mexico City, Mexico. July 20-24, 2026. [[LINK](#)]

Center for the Study of Race, Ethnicity & Equity. Graduate Fellows Program - Race & Ethnicity Scholar (\$4,000), 2025-2027. [[LINK](#)]

GRANTS AND AWARDS

Internal Grants and Awards

Global Programs, Brown School. Global Programs Fund (\$1,000), May 2026.

Global Programs, Brown School. Khinduka Global Professional Development Fund (\$1,000), November 2025.

CFU Graduate Professional Student Council. Second Place in Social Science, 30th Annual Graduate Research Symposium (\$150), March 2025. [[LINK](#)] [[LINK](#)]

Center for Human Rights, Gender and Migration. 2024 Seed Grant (\$2,500), June 2024-June 2025. Role: PI; co-PI: Mitra Naseh. “Quality of Life of Highly Educated Iranian Immigrants and Restrictive Migration Policies.” [[LINK](#)]

Center for the Study of Race, Ethnicity & Equity. Graduate Student Conference Travel Award (\$750), October 2024. [[LINK](#)]

Global Programs, Brown School. Global Programs Pilot Research Fund (\$2,500), February-June 2024. Role: PI; co-PI: Mitra Naseh. “Breaking Barriers: Unraveling the Impact of Financial Aid Policies on Social Mobility for DACA Recipients.” [\[LINK\]](#)

External Grant Proposal

Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL), Displaced Livelihoods Initiative pilot proposal, June 2025-May 2026. Role: PI; co-PIs: Mitra Naseh, Patrick Fowler, and Zakira Hekmat. “Bridging Economic and Mental Health Support: A Community-Informed RCT for Afghan Refugees in Türkiye” (\$50,000; **Finalist**; not funded).

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Immigrant Wellbeing and Technology Lab, University of Michigan, 2026-present. PI: Nari Yoo, Ph.D.

Research Assistant, Forced Migration Initiative, Washington University in St. Louis, 2023-present. PI: Mitra Naseh, Ph.D.

Social Position and Administrative Barriers in the Multidimensional Economic Integration of Newly Resettled Afghans [\[LINK\]](#); Economic Integration of Newly Resettled Afghans Project [\[LINK\]](#); Projects include research on ethnic networks and health disparities among Afghan refugees [\[LINK\]](#); and Restrictive migration policies and the well-being of highly educated immigrants [\[LINK\]](#)

Research Assistant, Center for Innovation in Child Maltreatment Policy, Research and Training, Washington University in St. Louis, 2023-present. PI: Melissa Jonson-Reid, Ph.D.

Research Assistant, Child Maltreatment Prevention Lab, University of Michigan, 2022-2023. PI: Kathryn Maguire-Jack, Ph.D.

Research Assistant, Division of Social Cohesion Research, Korea Institute for Public Administration, 2018-present. PI: Dongjae Jung, Ph.D. Contributed to the execution and publication of eight government-commissioned academic papers related to refugees and undocumented and immigrant workers in Korea.

Editorial Research Assistant, Journal of the Korean Council for Children’s Rights, 2021-2023.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Co-Instructor, Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis, Spring 2026. “Evaluation of Programs and Services” (Online, S50-6001) [MSW].

Teaching Assistant, Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis, Fall 2026. “Social Welfare Policies & Services” (S15-4100) [MSW].

Teaching Assistant, Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis, Fall 2024. “Social Work Practice with Refugees and Immigrants” (S31-5007) [MSW].

Teaching Assistant, Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis, Summer 2024. “Evaluation of Program and Services” (Online, S50-5050) [MSW].

Teaching Assistant, Brown School, Washington University in St. Louis, Spring 2024. “Policy and Service for Children and Youth” (S40-5771) [MSW].

Guest Lecturer, “Immigration Today (BA)” University of Wisconsin Whitewater, Fall 2026.

Guest Lecturer, “English Language Programs (MSW/MPH)”, Washington University in St. Louis, Fall 2025

Guest Lecturer, “Human Behavior and the Social Environment (BA)”, Chung-Ang University, Spring 2024.

Grading Assistant, East Asian Languages and Cultures, Washington University in St. Louis, Fall 2024-Spring 2025. “Basic Korean, Korean I, and Korean II.”

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

Community Presentations

Lee, J., Bechara, S., Zeng, Y., & Naseh, M. Multidimensional Poverty Among Newly Resettled Refugees in the U.S., Evidence from the Annual Survey of Refugees [Oral Presentation]. Community Hearing Session. Clark-Fox Policy Institute, St. Louis, MO. April 1, 2026 [\[LINK\]](#) [\[LINK\]](#)

Naseh, M., **Lee, J.**, Zeng, Y., Nabunya, P., Alvarez, V & Safi, M. Measuring Economic Integration Among Immigrants and Refugees in the US: A Scoping Review [Oral Presentation]. Immigrant Service Provider Network (ISPN). St. Louis, MO. December 8, 2023.

Conference Presentations

Lee, J., Yoo, N., Bechara, S., Zeng, Y. & Naseh, M. Between Protection and Control: A Scoping Review of Artificial Intelligence Applications and Ethical Governance in Refugee and Immigrant Services [Poster]. SSWR. San Francisco, CA. January 20–24, 2027.

Lee, J., Bechara, S, Zeng, Y. & Naseh, M. Multidimensional Poverty among newly resettled refugees in the U.S., evidence from 2019-2021. [Oral Presentation]. APPAM. Boston, MA. November 5–7, 2026

Lee, J., Yoo, N., Bechara, S., Zeng, Y. & Naseh, M. Artificial Intelligence (AI) in Refugee and Immigrant Support: A Scoping Review [Oral Presentation]. CERC in Migration and Integration. Toronto, Canada. April 15-17, 2026

Lee, J., Naseh, M., Badiezadeh, S., Taridashti, S. & da Luz Scherf, E. Health Impacts of Migration and Policy on the Iranian Diaspora. [Poster]. SSWR. Washington, DC. January 14–18, 2026

Yoo, N., **Lee, J.**, Cureton, A. & Chow, C. Digital Mutual Aid in Precarity: Peer Support Among DACA Recipients on Reddit Across U.S. Administrations [Oral Presentation]. APPAM. Seattle, WA. November 13–15, 2025

Lee, J., Naseh, M., Zeng, Y. & Bechara, S. Multidimensional Deprivation and Discrimination Among Newly Resettled Afghans in the U.S. [Oral Presentation]. APPAM. Seattle, WA. November 13–15, 2025

Lee, J., Naseh, M., Badiezadeh, S., Taridashti, S. & da Luz Scherf, E. Health Impacts of Migration and Policy on the Iranian Diaspora. [Oral Presentation]. APPAM. Seattle, WA. November 13–15, 2025

Lee, J., Naseh, M., Ilkkursun, Z., Acarturk, C., Soylu, N. & Sohtorik Ilkmen, Y. From Policy Shifts to Lived Health Realities: A Phenomenological Study of Afghan Refugees in Türkiye. [Oral Presentation]. Global Health at WashU: Focus on Impact. St. Louis, MO. May 1, 2025.

Lee, J., Naseh, M., Bechara, S. & Zeng, Y. Multidimensional Deprivation Among Newly Resettled Afghans in the U.S. [Oral Presentation]. Graduate Research Symposium. St. Louis, MO. March 27, 2025.

Naseh, M., **Lee, J.,** Zeng, Y., Nabunya, P. & Alvarez, V. Understanding Economic Integration Refugee Populations: A Scoping Review of Concepts and Metrics [Oral Presentation]. In Conceptualizing Success and Integration Among Refugees: Perspectives from Research and Practice (Panel). IASFM20: Forced Displacement in an Urbanizing World: Yogyakarta, Indonesia. January 21–23, 2025.

Lee, J., Naseh, M., Brugger, L. & Alvarez V. Towards Integration: Unpacking the Complexities of Multidimensional Economic Integration of Refugees in the U.S. [Oral Presentation]. In Conceptualizing Success and Integration Among Refugees: Perspectives from Research and Practice (Panel). IASFM20: Forced Displacement in an Urbanizing World: Yogyakarta, Indonesia. January 21–23, 2025.

Naseh, M., **Lee, J.,** Zeng, Y., Nabunya, P., Alvarez, V. & Safi, M. Understanding Economic Integration in Immigrant and Refugee Populations: A Scoping Review of Concepts and Metrics in the United States [Oral Presentation]. SSWR. Seattle, WA. January 15-19, 2025.

Lee, J., Naseh, M., Badiezadeh, S. & Zamora Garcia, E. Pathways to Economic Integration: A Social Network Analysis of Multidimensional Barriers Faced by DACA Recipients [Oral Presentation]. APPAM. National Harbor, MD. November 21 - 23, 2024

Lee, J. Exploring Research Trends in Korea's after-School Academy Policy for Youth Using Keyword Network Analysis. [Oral Presentation]. SSWR. Washington, DC. January 10-14, 2024.

Naseh, M., **Lee, J.,** Zeng, Y., Nabunya, P., Alvarez, V. & Safi, M. Measuring Economic Integration Among Immigrants and Refugees in the US: A Scoping Review [Oral Presentation]. SSWR. Washington, DC. January 10-14, 2024.

FIELD EXPERIENCE

Social Worker, Sungji Child Welfare Center, Busan, Korea, March 2019-July 2023. Conducted assessments of essential service needs and interviews for case management.

Social Work Practicum, Chung-Ang University Social Welfare Center, Seoul, Korea, March-June 2018 (160 hours). Assisted in linking clients to community resources, including food banks and academies.

Social Work Practicum, Moon-Chon 7 Social Welfare Center, Gyeonggi-do, Korea, July-October 2017 (160 hours). Supported case management and program-effectiveness assessment for children.

ACADEMIC AND PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Ad Hoc Peer Reviewer

International Migration (2026); Journal of Human Rights and Social Work (2026); Journal of International Migration and Integration (2026); Journal of the Society for Social Work and Research (2026); Journal of Immigrant and Minority Health (2026); Archives of Public Health (2025).

Community and Volunteer Service

Korean Language and Culture Mentor for Korean Americans, June 2025-present. Provide weekly one-on-one Zoom mentoring focused on Korean language acquisition, cultural knowledge, and identity exploration.

Volunteer, Welcome Neighbor STL, September 2024. Supported a newly resettled Afghan refugee family in St. Louis through a family visit conducted with the Social Work Practice with Refugees and Immigrants course.

Fundraising Volunteer, Busan, Korea, July-November 2021. Raised \$12,940 from 526 sponsors across three projects supporting immigrant families and low-literacy older adults.

MEDIA AND PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

IASFM20 Podcast, June 2025. Featured in a conversation with Mitra Naseh and Akino Tahir about the economic integration of resettled refugees in the United States and the importance of multidimensional approaches beyond employment. [\[LINK\]](#)

STUDENT RESEARCH MENTORING

Laura Villegas, Doctoral Student, University of Georgia, 2026-present
Jason Tang, Undergraduate Student, Washington University in St. Louis, 2026

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS AND AFFILIATIONS

Professional Associations

International Association for the Study of Forced Migration, 2025-present
Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management, 2023-present
Society for Social Work and Research, 2022-present

Research Networks and Affiliations

UC Berkeley Interdisciplinary Migration Initiative, 2026-present
Social Work AI Network, 2026-present
Grand Challenges for Social Work: Immigration Working Group, 2026-present
CERC in Migration and Integration, 2026-present
Data Science & Artificial Intelligence (Special Interest Group) [SSWR], 2026-present
Refugee & Immigrant SIG (Special Interest Group), 2024-present
Immigrant Service Provider Network, St. Louis, 2024-present
Center for the Study of Race, Ethnicity & Equity, Graduate Student Affiliate, 2024-present